

» WORLD VIEW OF THE FORTNIGHT



« Our Olympic top five target is more achievable than ever according to the latest forecasts, which show that France could have its best Games since 1900. I don't want to put too much pressure, but it's sound, healthy pressure. — France President Emmanuel Macron »



« I think it's all about having fun and enjoying the process. We are always doing a lot of crazy stuff with the team. It's helped me to stay focused on the court. — Australian Open champion Aryna Sabalenka on her new pre-match rituals and warm-up routines »

1st

Reigning U.S. Amateur champion Nick Dunlap became the first amateur since 1991 to win a PGA Tour title, winning a back-nine showdown to capture the American Express tournament. Dunlap, a 20-year-old sophomore at the University of Alabama, sank the winning par putt from just inside six feet at the 18th hole to fire a two-under-par 70 at the Pete Dye Stadium Course — one of three courses used. Despite his victory, however, Dunlap will not take home any money from the win. As an amateur, he is ineligible

for the winner's prize of \$1.51 million, which goes to runner-up Christiaan Bezuidenhout, who finished on 260 after a closing 65. Dunlap finished on 29-under 259 to set a 72-hole record low winning score, breaking the mark of 28-under set by Patrick Reed in 2014.



5.80

Pole vault world record holder Armand Duplantis opened his year by clearing a modest 5.80 metres indoors as he won in Astana.

It was the first time since 2019 that he had started a year by failing to clear six metres.

The 24-year-old Swede, who last summer raised his world record to 6.23m, started by clearing 5.60m. He then failed twice before clearing 5.80 m, but failed three times at 6.00m. Duplantis still won the competition in Astana, the first big meeting of the winter, ahead of Belgium's Ben Broeders (5.70m).

SEEKING JUSTICE



Swimmer Lia Thomas, who became the first transgender woman to win the highest U.S. national college title in 2022, has lodged a case with the Court of Arbitration for Sport (CAS) in a bid to again compete in elite female races. In June 2022, World Aquatics voted to ban transgender women who had gone through male puberty from competing in women's races. The 25-year-old American has lodged a case with the CAS to overturn the ban. AP